

FM

MBA · meerut university
Based on 4 year(s) of previous papers

Topic Priority Overview

Topic	Priority	Confidence	Freq	Marks
Management: Definition & Meaning	High	High	4×	Short/Very Short (3 marks) and Long
Importance/Reasons for increasing importance of management	High	High	3×	Mostly 15 marks when paired with definition/essay; sometimes
Administration vs Management — Differences	Medium	Medium	2×	7.5-15 marks
Process of Planning	High	High	3×	7.5-15 marks (appears both as short and detailed)
Objectives of Planning	Medium	Medium	2×	7.5-15 marks
Planning vs Controlling Relationship	Medium	Medium	2×	7.5-15 marks
Decision Making: elements	High	High	3×	Often part of 15-mark long questions
Delegation of Authority	High	High	4×	Short to long (3-15 marks)
Control: importance	High	High	3×	Often part of 15-mark long questions
Motivation: definition, nature & styles	High	High	4×	Short to long (3-15 marks)
Maslow's theory of motivation	Medium	High	3×	Short to medium (3-15 marks)
Coordination	Medium	Medium	2×	Short (3-7.5 marks)
Leadership: styles	Medium	Medium	3×	Short (3-7.5 marks)
Scientific Management	Low	Medium	1×	Very short (3 marks)
Communication: definition & types	High	High	4×	Short to long (2-15/22.5 marks)
Centralisation vs Decentralisation	Medium	Medium	2×	7.5-15 marks when asked
Planning and Controlling relationship	High	High	3×	7.5-15 marks
Directing: concept, principles & techniques	Medium	Medium	2×	15-22.5 marks when detailed

Detailed Study Notes

Read these notes carefully — they're based on actual patterns found in your past papers.

1. Management: Definition & Meaning

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 2-4 | Long: 2-3

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Exact wording: "What do you understand by management?" (definition demand)
- "What is management? Explain the nature and significance of management." (difference between definition and nature/significance)
- "Management is art or science or both." (essay style evaluation)
- Common elements asked: functions/characteristics as listed in questions (e.g., nature, significance, universality)
- Reasons for increasing importance often requested alongside definition (see Paper 1 wording)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short definitional prompts (3 marks) and long essay prompts demanding nature/significance or critical discussion (15/22.5 marks). Same phrasing: "What do you mean by Management?" or "What is management? Explain..."

Repeat Pattern:

Har saal seedha "What do you mean by management?" ya "What is management?" aaya — consistent short + long variations across all 4 papers.

Key Terms:

definition

nature

significance

art or science

2. Importance/Reasons for increasing importance of management

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Long: 2-3

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Exact phrase: "reasons for increasing importance of management in modern age" (Paper 1)
- Points usually requested: industrialisation, complexity of organisations, dynamic environment, technological change (these are the specific reasons papers expect)
- When asked with definition: tie reasons to "significance of management" as per Paper 2 Q9 wording
- In essay 'significance' questions, expect to explain 5-6 concrete reasons with brief examples

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Mostly long-answer essay prompts: "Discuss the reasons for increasing importance of management in modern age" or included in "nature and significance" style questions

Repeat Pattern:

Appears repeatedly as part of a long question on management's importance/nature in 3 papers — stable pattern.

Key Terms:

importance

modern age

significance

reasons

3. Process of Planning

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 1-3

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Direct phrasing: "Explain the process of planning." (Paper 1 and Paper 3)
- Specific process steps expected: establishing objectives, developing premises, identifying alternatives, evaluating alternatives, selecting course of action, implementing and follow-up
- Also be ready for "objectives of planning" as separate bullet (Paper 3 asks objectives and process)
- When paired with other topics (planning vs controlling) expect contrasts in steps and timing

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Usually a separate short/long answer: "Discuss the process of planning" or combined with objectives — expect structured stepwise answer

Repeat Pattern:

Appeared in 3 papers in same phrasing — high repeat and similar required steps.

Key Terms:

process

objectives

steps

planning

4. Decision Making: elements

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 0-1 | Long: 1-2

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Memorise and be able to list and explain the main elements/components of decision-making: identification of problem, objectives, criteria, alternatives, analysis/evaluation, choice/selection, implementation, follow-up/feedback.
- Be ready to give brief practical examples for each element (e.g., problem identification in production delays).
- Understand difference between 'elements' (components) and 'process' (sequence of steps) because exams ask both separately.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as part of long essay: "Explain and discuss the main elements of decision making." (Paper 1). Expect structured headings for each element.

Repeat Pattern:

Appears in multiple papers as an explicit demand for 'elements' or 'main elements' — treat it as a repeat high-value subtopic.

Key Terms:

elements

problem identification

alternatives

implementation

feedback

5. Delegation of Authority

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 4 · Paper 3 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 1-2

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Learn the definition, necessity/advantages of delegation, and key factors to keep in mind while delegating (clarity of authority, matching responsibility, accountability, competence of subordinates).
- Practice short definition: "Write the meaning of delegation of authority." (Paper 4) and longer answers covering why necessary and factors to consider (Paper 1).
- Also be able to contrast delegation with decentralisation when required.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Appears both as a VSA/short definition and as a multi-part 15-mark question asking meaning, necessity and factors (Paper 1 & 4).

Repeat Pattern:

Frequent across papers; often paired with decentralisation/delegation comparisons.

Key Terms:

delegation

authority

necessity

factors

6. Control: importance

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 0-1 | Long: 1-3

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Learn formal definition of control and be ready to discuss its importance/significance in business management: ensures goal attainment, coordination, efficient use of resources, minimises deviation, provides feedback for planning.
- Prepare 6-8 importance points with brief illustrations (e.g., quality control ensures product standards).
- Be ready to link importance to principles of controlling when required.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Direct long-question wording: "What do you understand by control? Discuss its importance in business management?" (Paper 1).

Repeat Pattern:

Appears repeatedly as a core long-question topic across papers.

Key Terms:

control

importance

coordination

feedback

7. Motivation: definition, nature & styles

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 1-3 | Long: 1-3

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Be able to define motivation, explain its nature (intrinsic vs extrinsic, individual differences), and list different styles/types of motivation (financial vs non-financial, positive vs negative).
- Prepare importance of motivation and link to performance; include one-two examples (e.g., incentives, recognition programs).
- Expect both short definition style questions and longer theory/importance questions (Paper 1 & 3).

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Appears as both a definition + discuss-nature/styles (Paper 1) and as importance/theory (Paper 3).

Repeat Pattern:

Consistently asked; combine conceptual clarity with examples for high marks.

Key Terms:

motivation

nature

styles

importance

8. Communication: definition & types

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · Paper 1 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 1-3 | Long: 1-3

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Learn a clear definition of communication and main types: verbal/written, formal/informal, upward/downward/horizontal.
- For Paper 4, memorise characteristics of good communication separately (clarity, completeness, correctness, conciseness, timeliness, feedback).
- Be prepared to give examples and discuss importance/role in directing and control.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Appears both as a VSAQ/short answer (definition/types) and as longer questions asking characteristics of good communication (Paper 4) or types (Paper 3).

Repeat Pattern:

Consistently asked across all papers in both short and long formats.

Key Terms:

communication

types

verbal

written

formal

9. Planning and Controlling relationship

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 1 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 1-2

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Learn the common exam phrasing: "Planning is looking ahead and controlling is looking back." Be ready to explain and justify this statement.
- Key points: planning sets standards/targets; control compares actual with standards and provides feedback; control aids future planning through feedback loop.
- Provide examples showing how planning provides benchmarks for control (e.g., production targets and quality checks).

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as a quote explanation or comparison: "Explain the relationship between planning and controlling" (Paper 2) or as the quoted line (Paper 1).

Repeat Pattern:

Often paired across papers — a staple comparative question.

Key Terms:

planning

controlling

relationship

10. Administration vs Management — Differences

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 0-1

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Exact demand: "Explain the difference between Administration and Management." (Paper 1)
- Points to list: nature of admin vs management, scope, level (top-level vs all levels), policy-making vs implementation — expected in answers
- When asked compare: provide pointwise comparison (usually 6-8 pairs)
- Be ready to give examples of functions typically attributed to administration vs management

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Direct compare/contrast question (short answer 7.5 marks) using wording "difference between Administration and Management"

Repeat Pattern:

Appeared in Paper 1 and Paper 2 as a straight comparison question — moderately consistent.

Key Terms:

administration

management

difference

comparison

11. Objectives of Planning

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 3 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1-2

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Exact phrase: "What are the objectives of planning?" (Paper 3)
- Typical objectives expected: certainty, direction, efficient use of resources, coordination, control basis
- Prepare 6-8 objectives with 1-2 line explanation each — question expects list format
- When paired with process, mention how specific objectives feed into steps

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short answer (7.5 marks) list-style question asking for objectives specifically

Repeat Pattern:

Asked in Paper 3 and implied in Paper 2's planning questions — moderate repeat

Key Terms:

objectives

planning

coordination

12. Planning vs Controlling Relationship

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 1 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 1

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Exact wording: "Explain the relationship between planning and controlling?" (Paper 2)
- Key comparison points tested: planning is looking ahead, controlling is looking back (Paper 2 & 1 phrasing)
- How planning provides standards for control, and control provides feedback to planning
- Be ready to contrast timing, function, and dependency with examples

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short/medium answer (7.5 marks) with comparison and explanation; sometimes asked as quote + explain: "Planning is looking ahead and controlling is looking back."

Repeat Pattern:

Explicit phrasing seen in Paper 2 and concept also in Paper 1 — consistent pairing.

Key Terms:

planning

controlling

relationship

feedback

13. Maslow's theory of motivation

High Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 1-2

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Memorise Maslow's five hierarchy levels: physiological, safety, social, esteem, self-actualisation and short examples for each.
- Be ready to "discuss Maslow's theory in brief" (Paper 1) and to describe the hierarchy (Paper 2). Also prepare criticisms/limitations briefly for longer answers.
- Link levels to workplace motivators (e.g., job security -> safety needs).

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as a specific theory question: "Discuss Maslow's theory of motivation in brief" or "Describe the Maslow's hierarchy of needs."

Repeat Pattern:

Frequently appears whenever motivation/theory is asked; treat as a must-know model.

Key Terms:

Maslow

hierarchy

physiological

14. Coordination

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 1 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 0-1

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Be able to define coordination simply and list methods to achieve coordination (policies, meetings, committees, standard procedures).
- Have 3-4 short points on importance and how coordination differs from control/communication.
- Prepare a tiny example (project team coordination) for 3-mark answers.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Often appears as a very short answer: "What is co-ordination?" (Paper 2).

Repeat Pattern:

Appears in VSA section — quick definitional answer expected.

Key Terms:

coordination

integration

methods

15. Leadership: styles

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 1 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-3 | Long: 0-1

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Prepare definitions of common leadership styles: autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire; be able to state advantages/disadvantages and one-line situational suitability.
- Also know brief mentions of transactional/transformational or situational leadership if asked.
- Practice a short example demonstrating each style in a workplace.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short answer prompts like "What do you mean by Leadership style?" (Paper 2) or as part of defining leadership (Paper 3).

Repeat Pattern:

Repeated as short definitional items across papers.

Key Terms:

leadership

autocratic

democratic

laissez-faire

16. Centralisation vs Decentralisation

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 4 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 | Long: 1

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Prepare pointwise distinctions between centralisation and decentralisation: locus of decision-making, advantages/disadvantages, effect on initiative and control.
- Be ready to discuss suitability based on organisation size and environment and to contrast with delegation.
- Give 4-6 comparative points and an example (e.g., centralised firm HQ vs divisional decentralisation).

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short essay/compare question: "Distinguish between centralisation and Decentralisation." (Paper 2).

Repeat Pattern:

Appears periodically, often paired with delegation/decentralisation comparisons.

Key Terms:

centralisation

decentralisation

decision-making

17. Directing: concept, principles & techniques

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 0-1 | Long: 1-2

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Understand directing as a managerial function: concept, key principles (unity of command, clear communication, discipline, motivation) and techniques (supervision, leadership, motivation, communication, delegation).
- Practice explaining how directing integrates with other functions (planning, organising, controlling).
- Expect a structured long answer: define, list principles, explain techniques with short examples.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Long-answer demand: "Discuss concept, principles & techniques of directing." (Paper 3) and related short prompts in Paper 4.

Repeat Pattern:

Appears as a core part of section on directing across multiple papers.

Key Terms:

directing

principles

techniques

supervision

18. Scientific Management

Medium Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Know a concise definition of scientific management (Taylor) and its key features: time-study, scientific selection & training, standardisation, piece-rate incentives.
- A 2-3 line definition with 2 hallmark features is sufficient for the VSAQ format.

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Appears as a very short answer: "What is scientific management?" (Paper 2).

Repeat Pattern:

Appears occasionally as a quick theory/definition question.

Related Topic Pairs

Yeh topics exam mein aksar ek saath poochhe jaate hain — inhe milake padho.

1. Planning (Process/Objectives) <-> Controlling (principles/types): planning is used as standard for control; multiple papers asked planning vs controlling together

2. Delegation of Authority <-> Delegation vs Decentralisation / Centralisation: delegation questions were frequently paired with decentralisation or centralisation comparisons

3. Motivation (definition/nature) <-> Maslow's Hierarchy: Maslow often appears as the specific theory when motivation is asked

4. Organisation: Types/Forms <-> Organisation Structure: types — both asked separately but commonly combined in long answers about forms and structures

Apni Strategy Chuno

Pick your goal — here's exactly which topics to study based on past paper patterns.

□ *Bas Pass Hona Hai*

Just want to pass — 9 of 18 topics · ~62% marks coverage

1. Management: Definition & Meaning
2. Delegation of Authority
3. Motivation: definition, nature & styles
4. Communication: definition & types
5. Importance/Reasons for increasing importance of management
6. Process of Planning
7. Decision Making: elements
8. Control: importance
9. Planning and Controlling relationship

□ *Average Score Chahiye*

Decent score — 17 of 18 topics · ~98% marks coverage

1. Management: Definition & Meaning
2. Delegation of Authority
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4. Communication: definition & types
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6. Process of Planning
7. Decision Making: elements
8. Control: importance
9. Planning and Controlling relationship
10. Maslow's theory of motivation
11. Leadership: styles
12. Administration vs Management — Differences
13. Objectives of Planning
14. Planning vs Controlling Relationship
15. Coordination
16. Centralisation vs Decentralisation
17. Directing: concept, principles & techniques

☐ Top Karna Hai

Full coverage — all 18 topics · 100% marks coverage

1. Management: Definition & Meaning
2. Delegation of Authority
3. Motivation: definition, nature & styles
4. Communication: definition & types
5. Importance/Reasons for increasing importance of management
6. Process of Planning
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16. Centralisation vs Decentralisation
17. Directing: concept, principles & techniques
18. Scientific Management

Overall Exam Strategy

Bas Pass Hona Hai: study these exact granular topics fully — "Management: Definition & Meaning", "Process of Planning", "Decision Making: Concept, Elements & Process", "Delegation of Authority: Meaning, Necessity & Factors", "Control: Definition, Importance & Principles", "Communication: Definition, Types & Characteristics", "Organisation: Definition & Different Types/Forms of Organisation", "Motivation: Definition, Nature & Styles". Yeh 8 topics cover repeated long/short questions across papers — specifically: definition/nature/significance of management (Qs every year), planning/process/objectives (repeated), decision-making (elements/process repeated), delegation/decentralisation (paired repeatedly), control (principles/types repeated), communication (types/characteristics repeated), organisation/forms (types/forms repeated), motivation + Maslow (repeated). Agar tum sirf in 8 granular topics pe focused answers likhoge — structured points, definitions, lists and 1-2 short examples — tum 40-50% of questions ko confidently attempt kar sakte ho because these themes appear in both Section-A/B/C across multiple papers. Extra tip: for remaining marks quickly revise short definitional items (scientific management, line organisation, unity of command, departmentation, supervision, parity between authority and responsibility) since they are small 3-7.5 mark items and easy to score.